36. The BJP did lose a big prestige battle in West Bengal to the Trinamool Congress in May 2021. However, the Bengal result must be seen in context. The BJP won seventy-seven seats (of the 292 that went to elections in the 294-member state assembly) and 38.3 per cent vote share in the May 2021 West Bengal state assembly election. This was down from the 121 state assembly segments it led in, with 40.3 per cent vote share, in the 2019 Lok Sabha polls. In comparison, the BJP had won only three seats (10 per cent vote share) in the 2016 assembly polls, two seats (18 per cent vote share) in the 2014 Lok Sabha polls and zero seats (4 per cent vote share) in the 2011 state election. In 2021, its vote share fell marginally from 2019, but seat share fell drastically because the election became a two-horse race—with the Congress (zero seats) and the CPI-M (zero seats) getting wiped out. For data comparisons, see TOI West Bengal datahub, available at: https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/elections/assembly-elections/west-bengal/constituency-map; also see Ashish Ranjan, 'Mamata vs BJP: who had the edge in Bengal's close contest seats?', *India Today*, 5 May 2021, https://www.indiatoday.in/elections/story/west-bengal-2021-assembly-election-result-analysis-tmc-bjp-1799196-2021-05-05.
37. Swapan Dasgupta, 'The right course', *Open*, 17 February 2020, p. 33.
38. Raj Chengappa, 'Modinomics 2.0', *India Today*, 7 February 2020, https://www.indiatoday.in/magazine/cover-story/story/20200217-modinomics-2-0-1643717-2020-02-07.
39. Nalin Mehta, Interview with Montek Singh Ahluwalia, 'If a bank chief isn't beholden to a FinMin joint secretary, he will behave differently', *The Times of India*, 16 February 2020, https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/blogs/academic-interest/if-a-bank-chief-isnt-beholden-to-a-finmin-joint-secretary-he-will-behave-differently-montek-singh-ahluwalia/.
40. The full paper is available at: https://www.hks.harvard.edu/sites/default/files/centers/cid/files/publications/faculty-working-papers/2019-12-cid-wp-369-indian-growth-diagnosis-remedies-final.pdf.